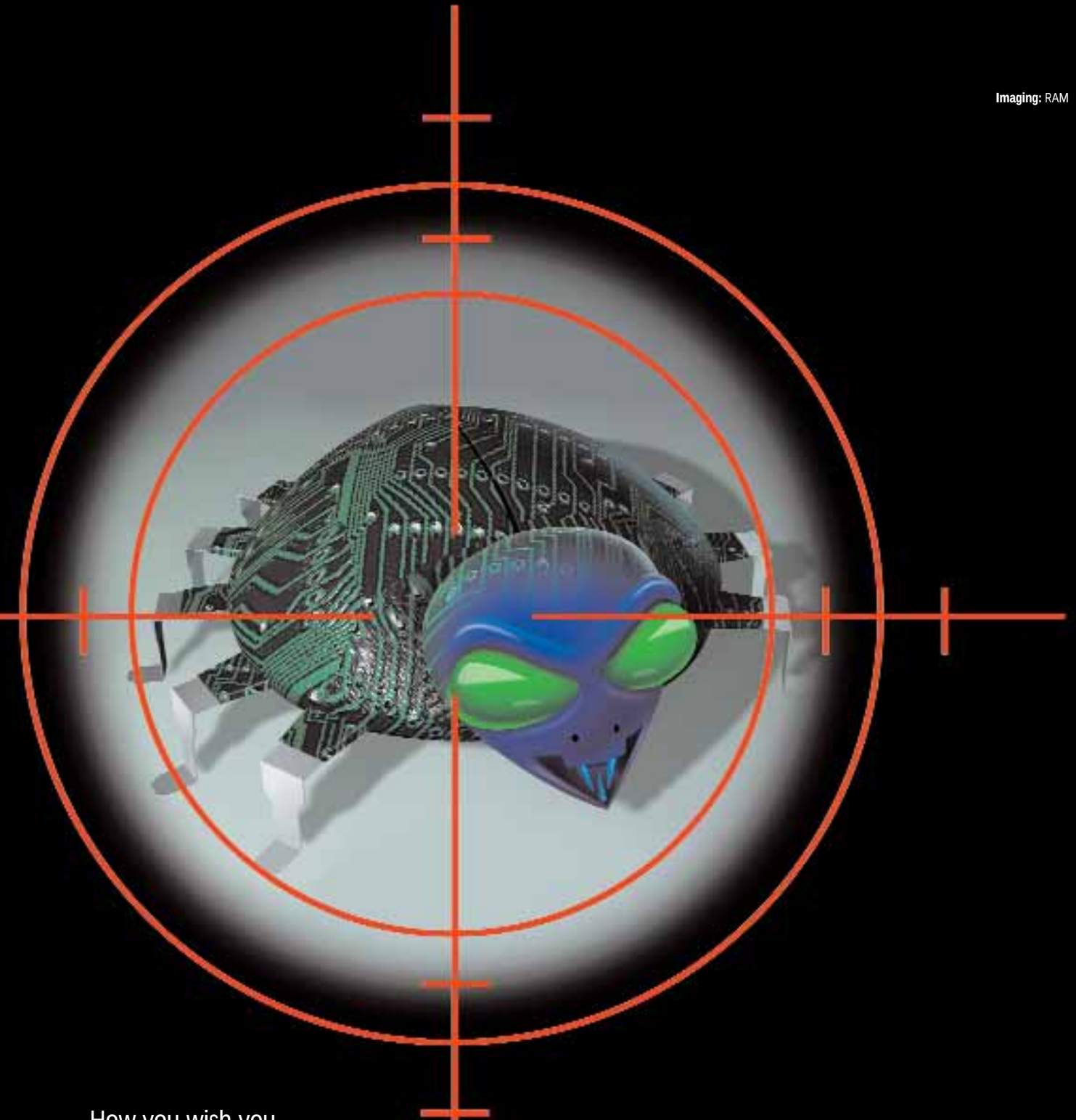




How you wish you could get rid of those viruses on your machine. A look at the top antivirus software for your needs

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Yikes, what is that weirdly named file on your hard drive? Is it a game? Is it a joke? Guess again—you're infected by a virus! With the advent of broadband Internet connectivity, DVDs and the ubiquitous CDs and floppy disks, there exist many potential ports through which malicious files and content can enter your computer. Add to that backdoors or certain sections in applications that developers keep open either wilfully or for development work. Potentially harmful files can be placed on your computer through these ports. Once this happens, there are

programs that can be used to monitor or even control the functioning of the infected computer.

So remember that the next time your kid sister downloads that new game from the Internet or one of the guys at work accesses a new Flash-enabled Web site, your home computer or office network could be subject to virus threats. The consequences of having a virus in your system could be anything—from an annoying message on your monitor, to a full-blown failure and corruption of your data, operating system and applications. So long as there is software, there will always be a certain breed of people who are intent